

HOW TO PLANT

To plant your Douglas Fir you will need to find a spot with lots of sunlight. These trees need plenty of light to grow healthy and will morph their shape to follow the sun.

Douglas Firs can grow to heights of about 320 feet tall and 20 feet wide. Plant these spaced about 15-20ft away from buildings, power lines, utilities, and streets to secure a long life.

These trees are adaptable and can grow in most of the Western United States. They prefer well-draining, acidic, silty clay loam for soil.

Avoid the errors shown on the right. Graphics by Department of Natural Resources.

Water during dry periods for the first couple years. Do not let the soil stay flooded. These trees are hardy so they require little care, but keep an eye out for signs of stress or disease such as discoloration in the needles.

QUESTIONS?

Email: Info@rutaverde.org
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Too shallow



Turned up roots



Tangled roots



Too deep



Rock



Air pocket

ABOUT

Ruta Verde Sustainability is a 501(c)3 nonprofit focused on the research of Indigenous sustainable practices such as Agroforestry, which mixes agricultural crops with native trees and shrubs to provide environmental and economic benefits:

ENHANCED BIODIVERSITY

Different plants invite different beneficial insects, bacteria, and fungi which build healthy soils

PROTECT WATER

Trees and plants with larger roots and increased biomass helps to hold and cleanse water.

HEALTHIER FOOD

Increased water retention and perennial root systems provide food that is more nutritious and more resilient

Agroforestry is one of the many techniques Indigenous people developed over centuries of interacting with the local environment. By learning and implementing these lessons into our modern practices we can create healthy and sustainable futures. If you'd like to support our work, check out our website, rutaverde.org



Gracias



DOUGLAS FIR (PSEUDOTSUGA MENZIESII)



The tallest of the Pine family, this species is popular due to its adaptability throughout much of western U.S. and it's thick bark that helps protect it from fires. They're easily identified by the pinecones, an old legend says the Douglas Fir offered its cones as protection for mice that were running scared during a fire. That's why they have the "legs and tail" popping out.

TREE FACTS

Scientific name:
Pseudotsuga menziesii
Family: Pinaceae
Class: Pinopsida
Genus: Pseudotsuga
Division: Pinophyta
Kingdom: Plantae
Growth rate: 2' - 3' per year



SEED HARVESTING

Douglas fir cones are best harvested in late summer, early fall. Mature cones are brown and dry, the cones should fall out with a tap of the conehead when ready. If the seeds are almost ready, they can be left in a dry spot to finish maturing until harvest. To plant, soak seeds for 24 hours, then freeze for 30-40 days to complete the stratification process.



FUN FACTS

Douglas-fir is also called red-fir, Oregon-pine, Douglas-spruce, and piño Oregon (Spanish), is one of the world's most important and valuable timber trees in the continent. It grows on the western side of Canada, U.S. and Mexico. This tree has adapted to grow in a variety of soils, but prefers well-draining silty clay loams. Douglas Firs are a pioneer in restoring degraded lands and strong enough to survive cold snowy winters and summer droughts.

ROLE IN THE FOREST

These massive trees that towers forests have many uses, including wind protection for smaller plants. Their branches and needles capture rainfall and slowly release it into the ground, helping to clean and store water in the aquifer to help survive the dry season.

USES

Douglas Fir is one of the best lumber trees in the states. With great veneer and strong resistant wood, this tree is often used to reforest lumber land.

Douglas Fir is also edible! The fresh pine needles are high in vitamin C, vitamin A, and antioxidants. They are often made into a tea. It is best to use the fresh growth needles that occur between March and June as they are most nutritious. Mature needles are also edible with an orange/pine-like flavor and Indigenous Peoples would eat them as a snack or to combat scurvy.

It is important to identify the tree properly as other pine needles can be toxic. Some say that it is not recommended to drink Douglas Fir Tea during pregnancy.

